

Geeta's Veena Frangetram



Setlist

Karunimpa

Shahana • Adi • Tiruvotriyur Tyagayyar

Siddhi Vinayakam

Shanmukhapriya • Rupaka • Muttuswami Dikshitar

Jagadananda Karaka

Nata • Adi • Saint Thyagaraja

Telisi Rama

Purnachandrika • Adi • Saint Thyagaraja

Ragam Tanam Pallavi

Kamavardhini • Khanda Jathi Triputa

Venkatachala Nilayam

Sindhu Bhairavi • Adi • Purandara Dasa

Bhajan Medley

Thillana

Mohanakalyani • Adi • Lalgudi Jayaraman

Mangalam

Karunimpa

Varnam

Ragam

Shahana

Talam

Adi

Composer

Tiruvotriyur Tyagayyar

The composition carries a heartfelt message—the first line, “Karunimpa idi manchi tarunamu saami,” translates from Telugu to “Now is the right time to protect me, my Lord,” expressing a sincere plea for divine grace. This piece combines lyrical devotion with melodic richness, offering a beautiful introduction to today’s performance and showcasing the emotional depth and musical elegance of the ragam.

Siddhi Vinayakam

Krithi

Ragam

Shanmukhapriya

Talam

Rupaka

Composer

Muttuswami Dikshitar

*This piece praises Lord Ganesha and his many roles.
The composer meditates on the form and actions of
Vinayaka as the son of Devi Parvati and Lord Shiva,
as the bestower of boons, and as he who is revered by
the Siddhas, Yakshas, Kinnaras, and countless others.*

Jagadananda Karaka

Pancharatna Krithi

Ragam

Nata

Talam

Adi

Composer

Saint Thyagaraja

One of Saint Thyagaraja's five famous compositions, known as the Pancharatna Krithis. As the name suggests, these pieces are touted as classical gems, praised for their thorough and beautiful expression of the ragams they're built on.

This piece is written in Sanskrit, differing from the other four Pancharatna Krithis which were all written in Telugu.

It is in praise of Lord Rama of the Hindu epic the Ramayana. Saint Thyagaraja praises Lord Rama as the source of all bliss in the universe, and tells of his life, his feats, and his values.

Telisi Rama

Krithi

Ragam

Purnachandrika

Talam

Adi

Composer

Saint Thyagaraja

This piece encourages the listener to meditate on and chant the name of Lord Rama, as he is the path to overcoming ignorance and worldly attachments.



Ragam Tanam Pallavi

Ragam

Kamavardhini

Talam

Khanda Jathi Triputa

A Ragam Tanam Pallavi is a cornerstone of Carnatic musical expression and improvisation. It showcases each artist's potential in a unique and creative way. Please feel free to listen in on this piece's intro for a more detailed explanation.



Venkatachala Nilayam

Devaranama

Ragam

Sindhu Bhairavi

Talam

Adi

Composer

Purandara Dasa

*This krithi is written in praise of Lord Venkateshwara,
the deity of Venkatachalam, and details his divine
features and righteous actions.*

Bhajan Medley

Geeta will perform a medley of notable bhajans, where she will demonstrate the concept of Shruthi Bhedam. Please feel free to follow and clap along as we display the lyrics on the screens!



Thillana

Ragam

Mohanakalyani

Talam

Adi

Composer

Lalgudi Jayaraman

Thillanas are rhythmic pieces often used in Indian classical dance performances. By nature, they are perfect pieces to showcase the interaction with the melody and percussion on-stage. Carnatic concerts usually end with a thillana, followed by a mangalam to bring the concert to an official close.

A woman in a red sari is seated and playing a veena. In the foreground, a mridangam drum is visible. The background is a soft, out-of-focus image of the same woman playing the veena.

Glossary

Some helpful words and phrases

Carnatic Music: *A South Indian classical performance art originating in Karnataka, India*

Ragam: *A piece's scale (or mode in Western theory)*

Talam: *A piece's meter or rhythmic pattern*

Veena: *An Indian classical string instrument.*

Played by Geeta

Mridangam: *A Indian classical drum, played on the sides.*

Played by Vid. Venkatesh Venkataraman (on Geeta's right)

Tabla: *A Indian classical drum, with two parts played on the top.*

Played by Vid. Ramanath Pai (on Geeta's left)